

2026 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP PROBLEM SOLVING U12 CANBERRA

NAME: _____

DATE OF BIRTH: _____

Please circle your age group:

- U8 (born after 1/1/2018!!)
- U10 (born after 1/1/2018!!)
- U12 (born after 1/1/2018!!)

Please circle: Boy or Girl

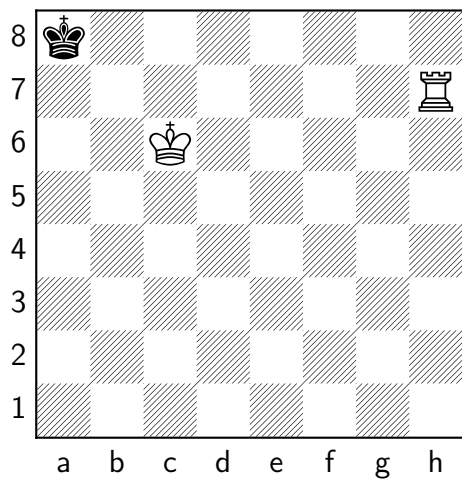
Please read the following rules.

- You have up to 2 hours for the problem solving paper. You may not need all that time. You can leave after handing in your answers.
- The questions go from easy to hard, so it's best to start at the beginning and go in order.
- You can use your chess board and pieces to help you.
- Each page show a question and a point you can obtain. Please write your answers in the space under each picture. Altogether, the test has 100 points. Even if you don't give perfect answers, you can still get some partial points.
- For endgame puzzles, try to show enough moves to reach a position where you are clearly winning or drawing.

- You don't have to finish them all, do your best and solve as many puzzles as you can.

Enjoy the problem solving.

Example 1. Mate in two.

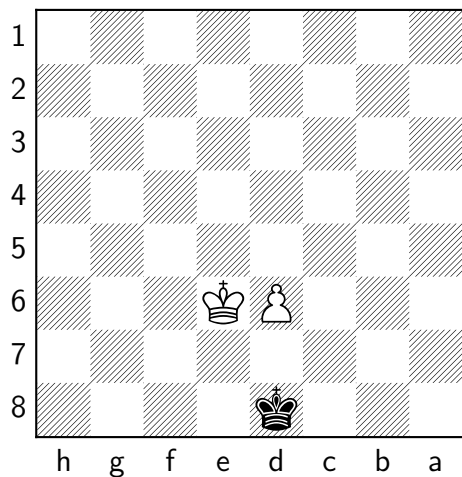


□ The open box shows White's move.

Answer:

1. Kb6 Kb8
2. Rh8# (1-0)

Example 2. Black moves and draws.



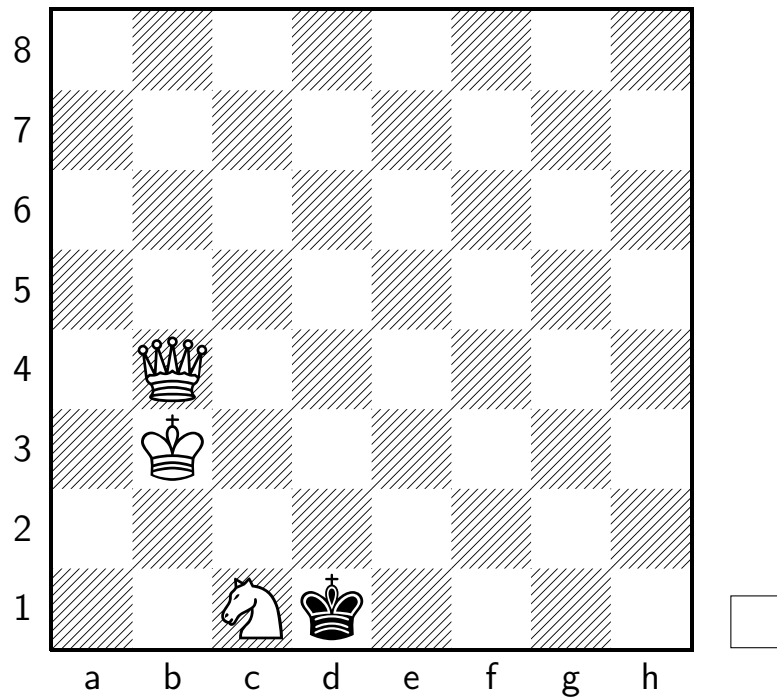
■ The closed box shows Black's move.

Answer:

1. ... Ke8
2. d7+ Kd8

2. Kd6 (draw)

Q1. Mate in two. (4 marks)



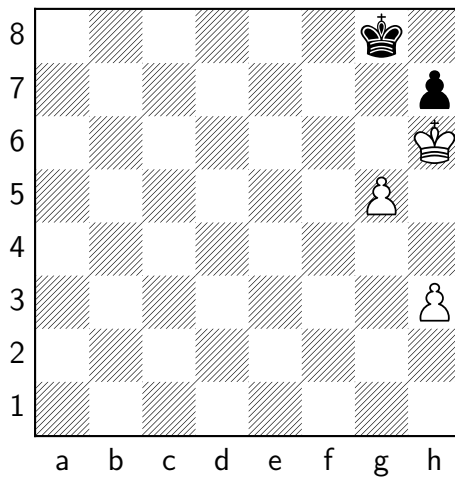
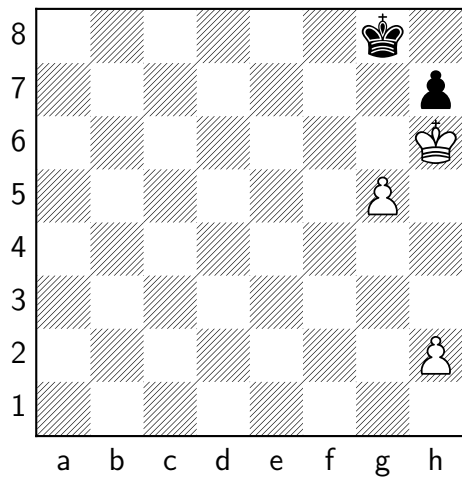
Answer:

1 ♔a5 ♕xc1
2 ♖e1#(1-0)(1-0)

Intention: Waiting move, forced capture (Easy warm-up)

Source: 9 Authors Deutsche Schachzeitung, 1968 (YACDB: 82713)

Q2. Is there any difference between left and right?



Answer:

White wins in left and draws in right.

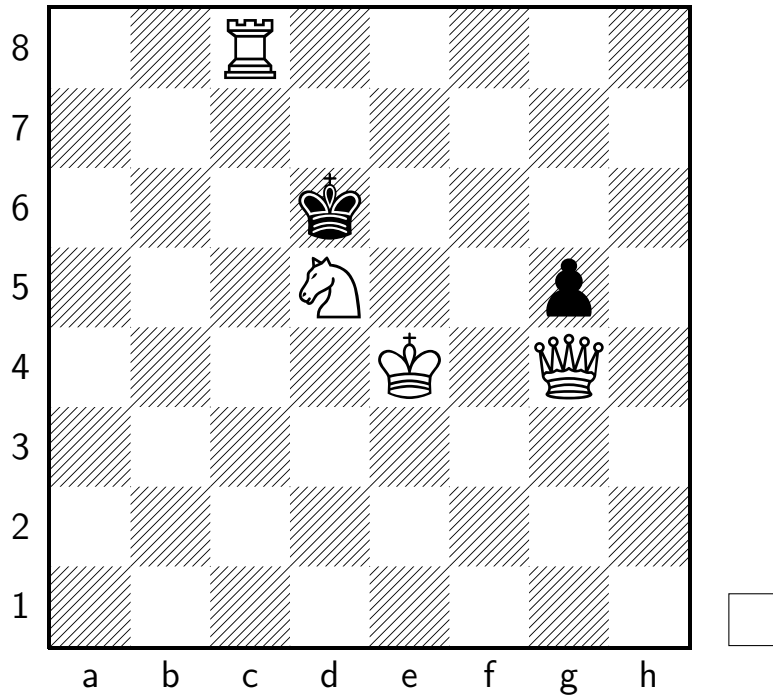
White wins as follow.

1 h3 ♔h8 2 h4 ♚g8 3 h5 ♔h8 4 g6 h×g6 5 h×g6 ♚g8 6 g7

Intention: endgame, tempo (Easy warm-up)

Source: Theoretical endgame

Q3. Mate in two.



Answer:

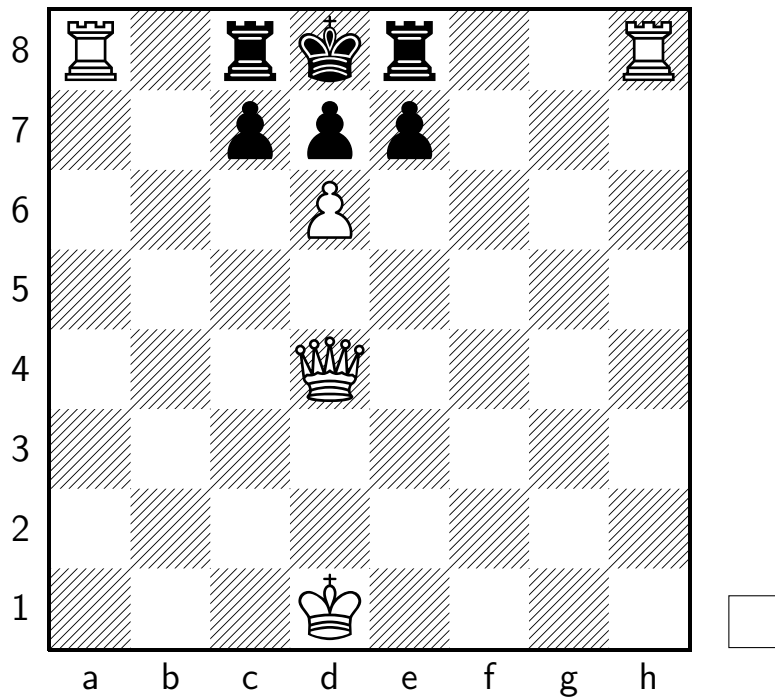
1 ♔f5 ♕d7 2 ♔e7#

1 ♔f5 ♕xd5 2 ♕d1#

Intention: King move (Easy warm-up)

Source: Samuel Loyd

Q4. Mate in two.



Answer:

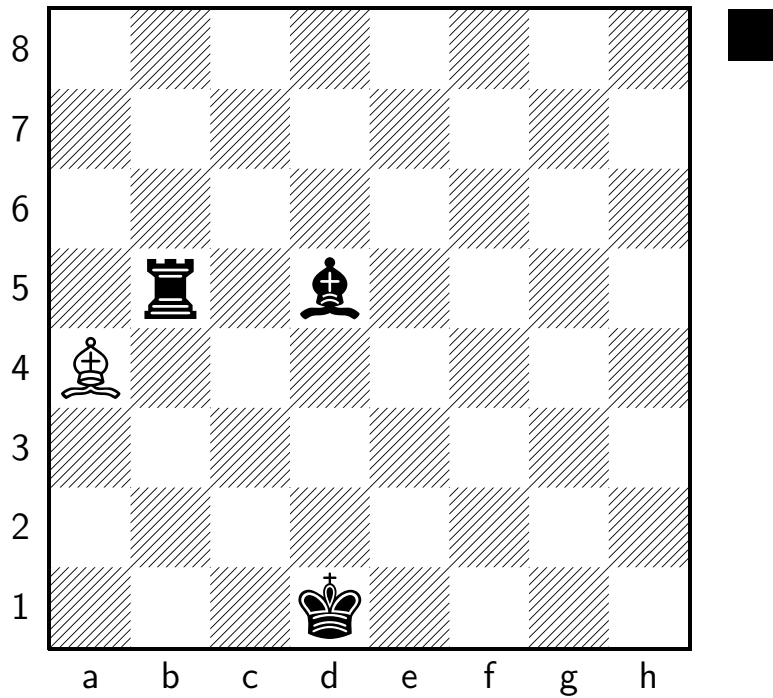
- 1 ♔c3 ♖xa1 2 ♔xc7#
- 1 ♔c3 ♖xh8 2 ♔xh8#
- 1 ♔c3 c6/c5 2 ♔a5#
- 1 ♔c3 cxd6 2 ♔xc8/Rxc8/Qa5#
- 1 ♔c3 e6 2 ♔xc8/Qf6#
- 1 ♔c3 e5 2 ♔xc8#
- 1 ♔c3 exd6 2 ♔f6#

1 ♔a1 (unsuccessful with 1...e5!)

Intention: Queen move (Medium?)

Source: Peter Wong, Chess in Australia 1988

Q5. This board is missing one piece. Answer the piece and its position, then write down the last few moves.



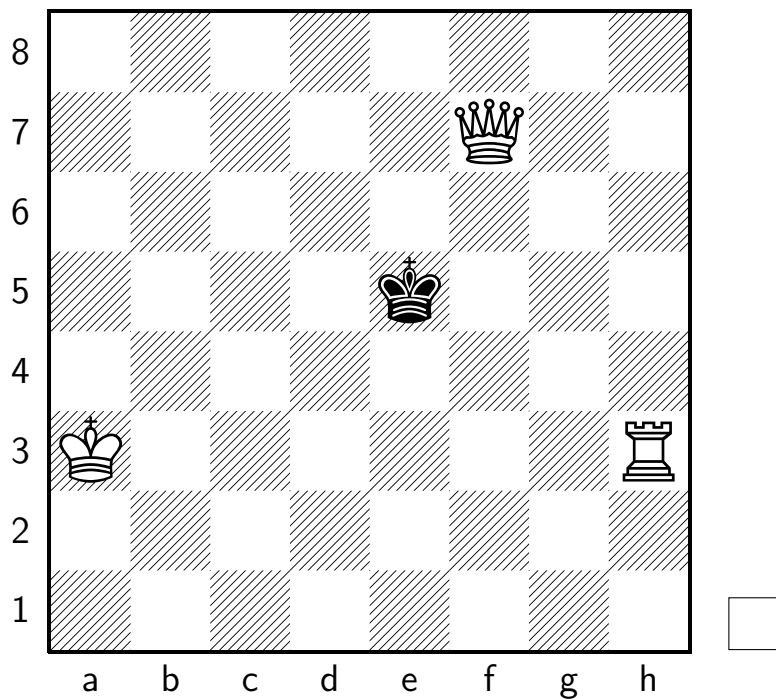
Answer:

1... ♖d5+
 2 c4... bxc3+
 3 ♔xc3+

Intention: Retrograde analysis, en passant (Medium?)

Source: Raymond M. Smullyan: The Chess Mysteries of the Arabian Knights

Q6. Mate in 3.



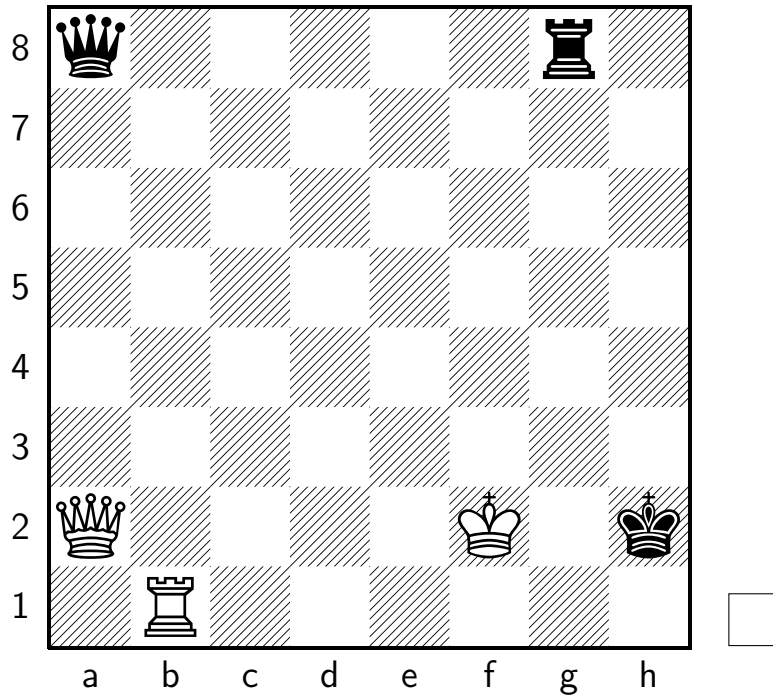
Answer:

1... ♔d5+
2 c4...bxc3+
3 ♕×c3+

Intention: Retrograde analysis, en passant (Medium?)

Source:

Q7. Show a winning sequence.



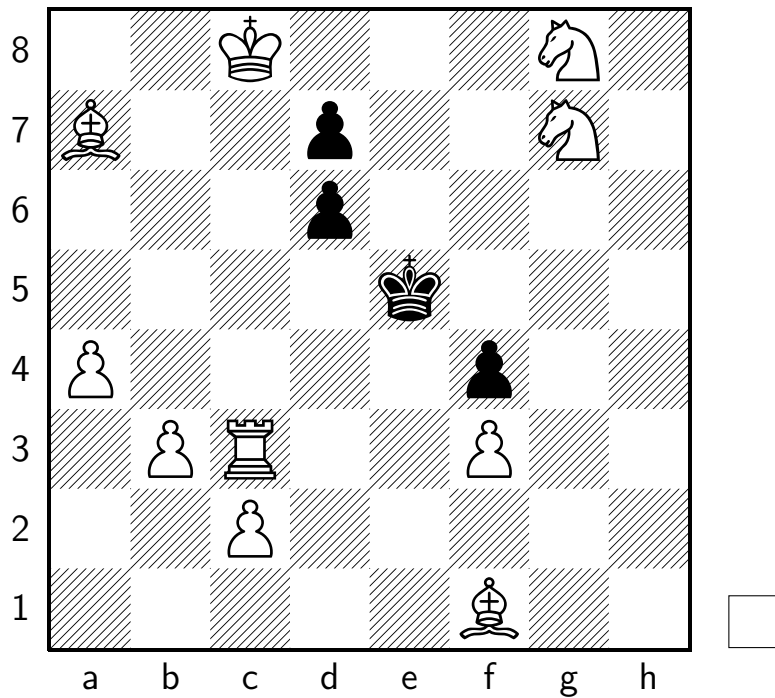
Answer:

1 ♖h1+! ♔xh1 2 ♕xg3
 1 ♖h1+! ♔xh1 2 ♕b1+ ♖g1 3 ♕h7#

Intention: Sacrifice (Easy?)

Source:

Q8. Mate in three.



Answer:

1 ♗g2! ♔d5 2 ♖e3 fxe3 3 f4#

1 ♗g2! ♔d5 2 ♖e3 ♕c6 3 ♘e7#

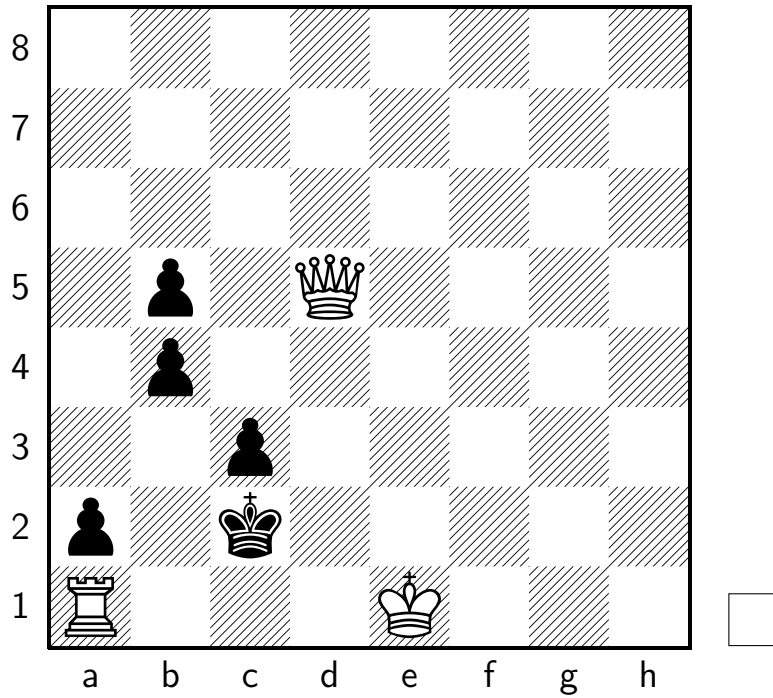
1 ♗g2! d5 2 ♕xd7 d4 3 ♖c5#

1 ♕d7 d5 2 ♖d3+ ♕e5 3 ♕c6 d5 4 ♖d5# (takes 4 moves)

Intention: Counterintuitive 1st move (Medium?)

Source: Thomas Denton Clarke, The Brisbane Courier 1918

Q9. Mate in two.



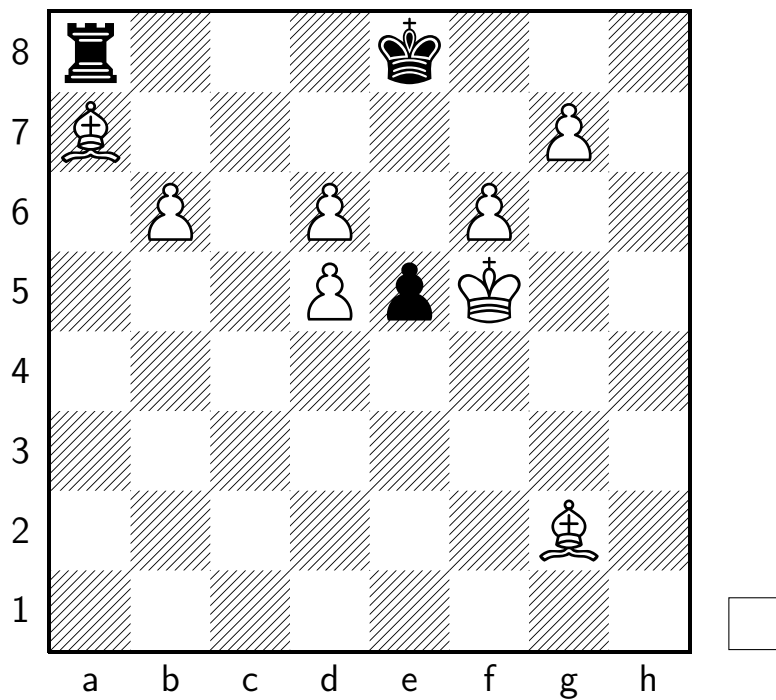
Answer:

1 ♔e6! ♚d3 2 O-O-O#(1-0)

Intention: Waiting move, castling (Medium?)

Source: William Whyatt

Q10. Mate in two.



Answer:

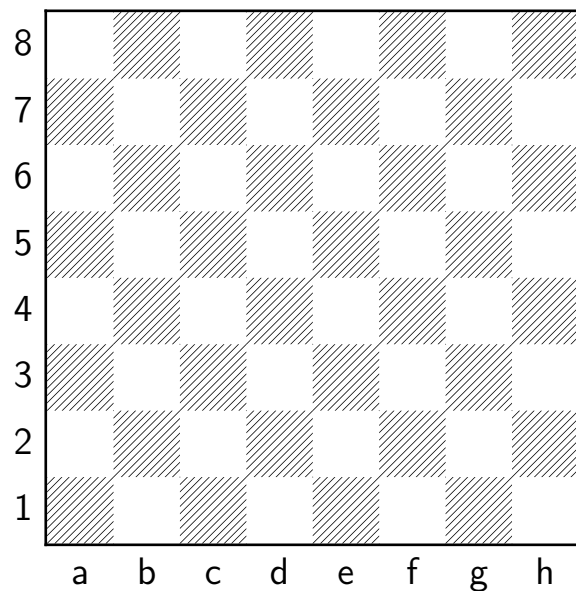
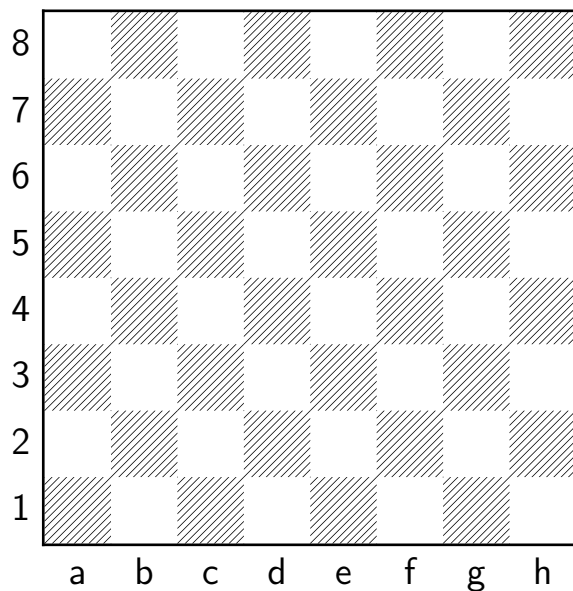
1 dxe6 ♔d7 2 g8♔#(1-0)

Intention:

Source:

Q14. 5 Queens Domination puzzle. Place 5 queens on the board so that all the squares are attacked by those 5 queens. (8 marks)

Do you know? There are 7,624,512 (${}_{64}C_5$) patterns to place 5 queens on the board. Among those pattern, 4,860 patterns are correct. In one episode of "Take Take Take" YouTube channel, Magnus Carlsen took about 5 minutes to complete this task. Can you beat him?

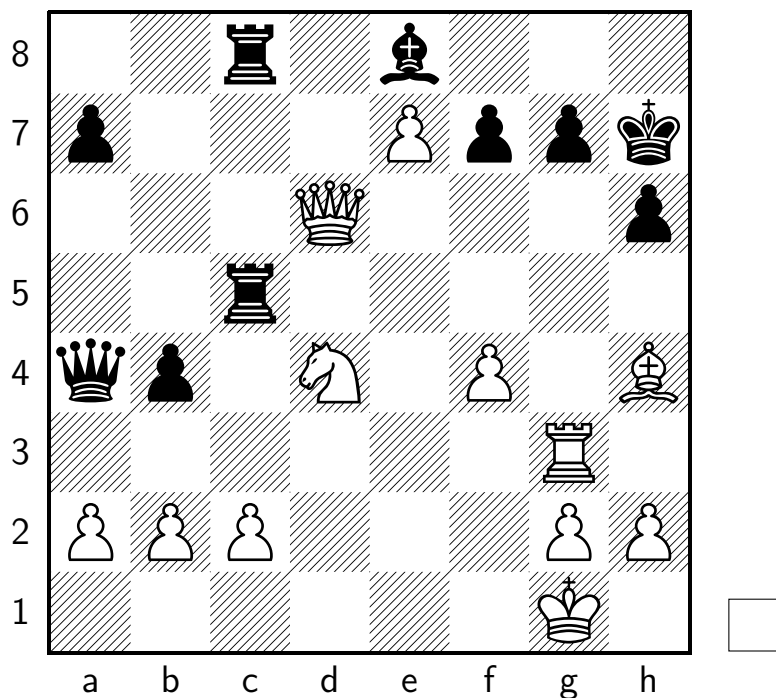


Answer:

Fill 5 squares in the left board with the letters "Q". When you make mistakes in the left board, put a large cross on the left board and use the right board.

Q15. Mate in eight. (8 marks)

In memory of Daniel Naroditsky (1995-2025). He is an American grand master, and he is famous streamer as "Danya". He tragically passed away in October 2025 at the age of 29.



Answer:

1 ♖xg7+! ♔xg7 2 ♚f6+ ♔g8 3 ♘e6 fxe6 4 ♚f8+ ♔h7 5 ♗f6 ♖g5 6 f×g5 ♔g6 7 g4 ♚xc3 8 ♚g7#

Intention: Might be long, but straightforward (Medium?)

Source: Daniel Naroditsky - Timur Gareyev 2020